year in which Yitzhak Rabin was elected to his second term as prime minister, the peace process became a cornerstone of government policy. As I mentioned above, in 1993 there were three parallel diplomatic processes—with Jordan, Syria, and the Palestinians. The 1996 elections brought the Likud back to power, this time with Benjamin Netanyahu at its helm. The 1991 intelligence assessment did not take into account a change of government in Israel. This is not unusual, however—assessments presented by the Israeli intelligence community never include analyses and forecasts regarding the variable of Israel itself. In contrast, net assessments take Israel's capabilities, intentions, and actions into account, but generally these assessments are made by the political leader with his senior aides, while taking the intelligence assessments into consideration and usually even after consulting with the heads of the various intelligence agencies.

In 1995 I established a team called Forum 2000, whose function was to discuss the threats and opportunities that the Mossad might face leading up to the end of the twentieth century and the beginning of the twenty-first. Because this was an internal organizational analysis, the team's mandate covered the following topics: (1) the international-strategic arena; (2) technology; (3) Israeli society; (4) the Israeli intelligence community.

At the outset, I outlined the work required of the team. I noted that the Mossad's mission consisted of several layers:

1. The Mossad needed to gather intelligence that addresses the threat perception. The intelligence had to be of the highest quality and also to be able to provide a response to the task of prevention and/or preemption with which the Mossad was charged.
2. The Mossad had to have research and assessment capabilities:
   (a) It had to enable the pluralism of research in the community.
   (b) The Mossad's research had to be at a level that gave it the ability to critique the intelligence output of other research bodies in the community.
   (c) The Mossad's research needed to expand to include EEI issues of a civilian nature, such as the maintenance of a strong economic sector.
3. The Mossad would continue to contribute to the development of the connection between Israel and the Jews of the Diaspora. This task would continue to be relevant in the era of the 2000s.